

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring

50-42

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

6

Manual Section Number

50-42

Manual Section Title

Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

04/01/2002

Ending Effective Date of this Version

07/01/2003

Implementation Date

04/01/2002

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Ambulatory blood pressure monitoring (ABPM) involves the use of a non-invasive device which is used to measure blood pressure in 24-hour cycles. These 24-hour measurements are stored in the device and are later interpreted at the physician's office.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

ABPM must be performed for at least 24 hours to meet coverage criteria.

ABPM is only covered for those patients with suspected white coat hypertension. Suspected white coat hypertension is defined as 1) office blood pressure >140/90 mm Hg on at least three separate clinic/office visits with two separate measurements made at each visit; 2) at least two documented blood pressure measurements taken outside the office which are <140/90 mm Hg; and 3) no evidence of end-organ damage. The information obtained by ABPM is necessary in order to determine the appropriate management of the patient. ABPM is not covered for any other uses. In the rare circumstance that ABPM needs to be performed more than once in a patient, the qualifying criteria described above must be met for each subsequent ABPM test.

For those patients that undergo ABPM and have an ambulatory blood pressure of <135/85 with no evidence of end-organ damage, it is likely that their cardiovascular risk is similar to that of normotensives. They should be followed over time. Patients for which ABPM demonstrates a blood pressure of >135/85 may be at increased cardiovascular risk, and a physician may wish to consider antihypertensive therapy.

Claims Processing Instructions

TN AB-01-188 (Program Memorandum Intermediaries/Carriers) [↗](#)

TN 10073 (Medicare Claims Processing) [↗](#)

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

149

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R149CIM.pdf> [↗](#)

Revision History

12/2001 - Changed status from non-covered to covered and clarified conditions under which ABPM is covered. Effective and implementation dates 04/01/2002. ([TN 149](#) [↗](#)) (CR

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring \(CAG-00067N\)](#) 
- [First reconsideration for Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring \(CAG-00067R\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring	3	07/02/2019 - N/A	View
Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring	2	07/01/2003 - 07/02/2019	View
Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring	1	04/01/2002 - 07/01/2003	You are here